ACCESS

AUSSTELLUNGSARCHITEKTUR, FRANKFURT, 2020



Access (2020) Frankfurt

As part of a collaboration with the Senckenberg Museum and the Frankfurter Kunstverein, YRD.Works conceived and realised the architectural intervention Access in 2020. For over a year, the temporary installation formed the spatial basis for the participatory exhibition Edmonds Urzeitreich – A Dinosaur Excavation in Frankfurt. From the outside, Access resembled a pile dwelling that stood out strongly from the museum's surrounding buildings through its timber construction and above all its colour.

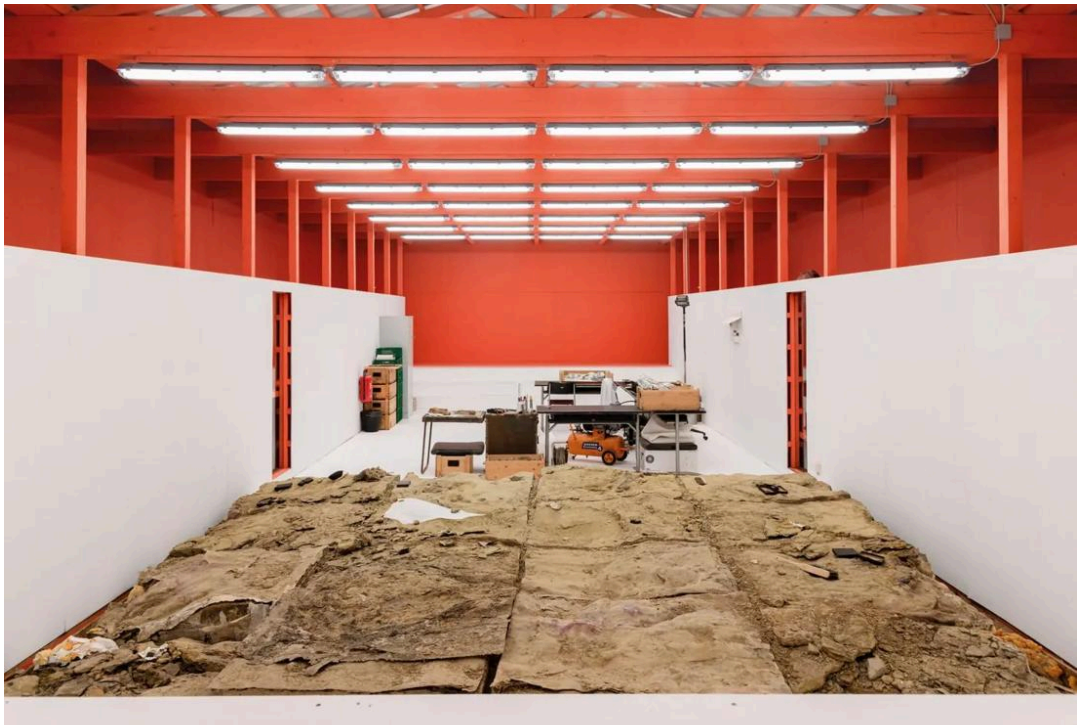
Inside the 21 x 9 x 5 metre timber structure was a so-called bonebed — a 20-square-metre block of rock full of fossil bones. The bonebed had been brought to Frankfurt from Wyoming, USA, especially for the exhibition and was uncovered and studied by a team of scientists.

YRD.Works divided the installation into two segments: an inner laboratory area where the excavation took place, and an outer area from which visitors could observe the scientific work.

The white interior served as a kind of white cube, transforming the laboratory area into a museum space. In this way, otherwise inaccessible scientific research was made visible, and the excavation work and the bonebed itself were highlighted as aesthetic objects. The laboratory area was surrounded by a coral-coloured outer area that visitors could walk through and that contrasted strongly with the neutral laboratory aesthetic of the interior.

A gently rising ramp running around the bonebed on all four sides allowed the audience to view the excavation site from different perspectives.

Grandstand-like steps at the ends of the interior and exterior spaces offered visitors places to sit. They served as interfaces between the public and the researchers, allowing those interested to ask questions and follow the excavation at close range.





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